

Chapter 182 Part 2: Extra Story 5-2

After finishing the conversation with the other parent, Xu Qingzhu put down her phone and chatted with Shen Hui, asking where Shen Fenghe and the others were.

Today wasn't any special day. If she had to name something, it should be the day Gu Yixue returned to the country.

Gu Yixue, who had been filming a new movie abroad, was returning to China today. Everyone had mentioned it when they were about to get off work, and so they all gathered at Liang Shi's home to eat.

It was just the younger generation.

Because Zhu Mingqi and Father Shen had gone on an expedition to the Arctic.

They had already been gone for a week, and the photos they sent were indeed spectacular.

The suggestion to explore the Arctic had actually come from Sheng Linlang.

At the time, they were having a family dinner when Zhu Mingqi brought up wanting to go out and have fun. She said that for most of her life, she had never traveled with her husband—it was more often business trips. She had been to all those Western European countries, just never had a chance to properly enjoy them.

If she went back now, she would only be reminded of the sad memories of those cities, so she didn't want to go.

But she still really wanted to travel.

So Sheng Linlang recommended the North and South Poles.

Both the Antarctic and Arctic had their own unique charm, and both were worth visiting.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised at the time, not knowing when Sheng Linlang and the others had gone to the poles.

Sheng Linlang smiled shyly, "I was too cooped up in those earlier years. It wasn't until after you joined the company that your dad and I had time to go out and enjoy ourselves."

It was only later, when Xu Qingzhu asked privately, that she learned Sheng Linlang had actually suffered from severe depression during that time.

She had been taking antidepressant medication all along.

Years of accumulated worries, rarely leaving the house on normal days—it had almost crushed Sheng Linlang entirely.

Fortunately, Xu Guangyao had stepped down from his position at that time and stayed by her side, and she slowly recovered.

Xu Qingzhu felt extremely guilty after hearing this, but Sheng Linlang told her not to take it to heart.

As for Zhu Mingqi, she took Sheng Linlang's advice and almost immediately started planning, taking Father Shen to both the North and South Poles.

Now there were only the younger generation at home.

Everyone was chatting about what genre Gu Yixue had been filming abroad when the doorbell rang.

Xu Qingzhu was just about to stand up to get the door when she noticed Mumu had already run all the way to the entrance.

She wasn't tall enough to reach the door handle, but she had moved a stool from nearby.

Normally, Xu Qingzhu kept a stool by the door to make it easier for them to change shoes, which now conveniently helped Mumu.

Mumu was an expert at being well-behaved in front of relatives.

The moment Gu Yixue saw her, she immediately picked her up. Being very observant, she noticed her red nose and eyes and asked: "Who bullied you? Why were you crying? Auntie will go get revenge for you."

Mumu shook her head: "I was the one who bullied someone else."

"Then why are you crying?" Gu Yixue was surprised.

Mumu buried her head in her neck, her voice muffled yet still milky: "I'm ashamed."

Everyone: "?"

Everyone burst out laughing at the same time.

Shen Fenghe, who had always been a woman of few words, had bought some fruit when she came and carried it all the way to the living room.

Although she had picked up Gu Yixue, she had no interaction with Gu Yixue the entire time.

Shen Hui even secretly asked her: "Did you have a fight with sister-in-law?"

Shen Fenghe was expressionless: "No."

On the other side, Liang Shi also asked Gu Yixue: "Did you have a fight with my sister?"

Gu Yixue tossed an apple into the air: "Do you think I'm worthy?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi looked at her with slight disdain: "Director Gu, when are you going to get your act together?"¹

Gu Yixue sneaked closer: "What? Want to see your sister get put in her place?"

Liang Shi: ".....I just think you're being too humble. I'm not telling you to bully my sister either."

Gu Yixue took a bite of the apple and laughed lightly: "I don't know what's wrong with her either."

There was some indifference in that laugh, tinged with confusion.

Liang Shi didn't know what to say either, and could only pat her shoulder comfortingly.

Gu Yixue took another bite of the apple, and a few seconds later, with lowered eyes, she said: "We might be getting divorced."

Liang Shi was cutting vegetables. Hearing this, she was so startled that her hand slipped, and the kitchen knife cut right into her hand.

Blood immediately flowed out.

She didn't even care about the pain and turned her head to ask: "What did you say?"

Gu Yixue glanced at her hand but didn't answer. Instead, she called out toward the outside: "Xu Qingzhu, your wife cut her hand."

Soon, the kitchen was crowded with people.

But Liang Shi was distracted.

She didn't care about her hand at all. Instead, she looked at Gu Yixue standing outside the crowd. She was leaning lazily against the wall, her whole demeanor showing dejection, holding a fresh apple in her hand, biting it carelessly.

The feeling she gave off was more like she was smoking a cigarette.

There was a ready-made doctor in the house. Although using her to bandage a knife wound was overkill, having her handle this kind of wound wouldn't make it feel painful.

Though it might also have been that Liang Shi was numb.

She really wanted to ask Gu Yixue what she meant, but she saw Gu Yixue, through the crowd of people, raise a finger to her own lips: "Shh."

Liang Shi lowered her eyes.

Since Liang Shi could no longer cook now, the kitchen became Zhao Xuning's domain.

After Gu Yixue finished her apple, she also came to help.

They didn't cook much—most of it was delivery that Shen Fenghe had ordered.

Before long, Shen Siyan arrived belatedly.

Shen Siyan had also joined the company now. Although he was a fresh graduate, he handled things decisively and efficiently.

Shen Fenghe was currently mentoring him. In Shen Fenghe's words, his edges were too sharp, but correspondingly, he had the vigor of youth.

Given time, he would definitely achieve great things.

The whole family ate together happily.

-
1. "支棱起来" (zhī léng qǐ lái) is internet slang meaning to pull oneself together, get one's act together, or become more assertive/confident. Here, Liang Shi is asking when Gu Yixue will stop being so humble and passive in her relationship. ⇐